

Just go to the String `image.animation_mode` and change it to "none" to stop all animated images, or to "once" to let them run. You can revert to the default behaviour using "normal".



The Annoying Blips!

`accessibility.typeaheadfind.enablesound` is by default set to True; the "Find as you type" feature makes a beep as you enter characters in a string that is not on the current page. The search field turns red anyway, so to turn the sound off, set that value to False.



How Often?

You can turn off automatic updating altogether, but some think a better idea is to select how often the checking for updates is done. `App.update.interval` determines how many seconds Firefox will wait between checking for updates (at the URL specified in `app.update.url`). The default is 24 hours (86400 seconds). You might want to change it to once a week or once a month.



Do You Need Tooltips?

Tooltips are shown by default when you hover your mouse over certain items, like when you hover it over the "new tab" button, you'll get something like "Opens a new tab." This is controlled by `browser.chrome.toolbar_tips`. Set it to False to disable tooltips. This will also disable tooltips to items on some Web pages.



A Possible Speed Enhancer #1

The `network.http.max-connections` setting determines how many simultaneous HTTP connections can be made. The default is 24 on most installations, but if you're on a fast connection, try increasing this value to, say, 48 to allow for more open connections—thereby speeding up browsing of multiple pages.

By increasing the value of this setting, you're only raising the maximum possible number of connections, not increasing the actual number of connections Firefox makes every time.



A Possible Speed Enhancer #2

`Network.http.max-connections-per-server` determines how many simultaneous connections can be made to a single server. The default is 8 or so. Try increasing the value for fast connections to something like 16 in an attempt to increase browsing speed. Setting this value very high, in conjunction with a high value for the settings mentioned after this one, could be interpreted by some servers as a DDoS (Distributed Denial of Service) attack, and your connection could be refused. It may also actually slow down your browsing, and



Bet You Didn't Know

Make That Button Useful

Did you know that you could put the animated square to the top right of the Firefox window to good use? By default, when you click on it, Firefox takes you to the Firefox Central page. You can change the String `browser.throbber.url` to whatever URL you want.

it's poor netiquette to pound servers with lots of connections from a single machine. Therefore, experiment with this value, but don't go too high.



A Possible Speed Enhancer #3

If you are connected to a proxy, `network.http.max-persistent-connections-per-proxy` determines how many connections to keep alive at any time. The default is 4; you can try a higher value (such as 8) to improve speeds. Raising this to a very high value will stress out the proxy server, and may ultimately result in slower browsing for everyone on the proxy. So this one depends on if you're callous and selfish—if it does lead to a performance increase, that is.



A Possible Speed Enhancer #4

If you are not connected to a proxy, `network.http.max-persistent-connections-per-server` determines how many connections to a single server to keep alive at any time. The default is probably 2; you can attempt a higher value (such as 4 or 8) to improve speeds. Similar to what was mentioned above, raising this to a very high value will stress the server you're connected to, and will either result in a refused connection, or slower response times from the Web page for every person trying to connect to it. Again, this one depends on how selfish you are...



Image Placeholders

Do you like image placeholders? Some of us do, some don't. It looks prettier if there is no placeholder, but then the placeholder gives you an idea of how large the image is... set `browser.display.show_image_placeholders` to True or False depending on your preference.



Highlighting In The Address Bar

`browser.urlbar.clickSelectsAll`, when set to True, makes clicking in the address bar automatically highlight all its contents. If you set to False, clicking in the address bar will just place the cursor where you click.



Switching Skins On The Fly

This is for those who have a lot of Themes (skins) for Firefox, and want to switch between them without having to

restart the browser for the new skin to kick in. The value in question here is the Boolean `extensions.dss.enabled`. If set to True, this option enables Dynamic Skin Switching. This means that whenever you change a theme in Firefox, its changes will be implemented and visible immediately.

Be warned that this can be buggy. Some elements in the newly-switched-to skin can become garbled. Test this one yourself to see if it's something you need.



The Mail Client To Use

When you click on a `mailto:` link—such as "contact me" or something like that—Firefox launches a mail client, such as Outlook or Outlook Express. The String `network.protocol-handler.app.mailto` contains the path to the application that handles e-mail links. In this setting, use the full path to the executable for your preferred mail client.



The Yellow Prompt

`Plugin.default_plugin_disabled` is a Boolean value that determines whether, when viewing a page that requires a plugin that's not installed, Firefox will prompt you to install the plugin. If you don't want to see such prompts, set this to False.



Text Selection #1

The Boolean value `layout.word_select.eat_space_to_next_word` determines the selection behaviour when you double-click on a word on a page. By default, Firefox selects the word and the whitespace to the right of that word. If you set it to False, Firefox will only select the word itself with no extra spaces.



Text Selection #2

Going along with the previous tip, `layout.word_select.stop_at_punctuation` determines whether Firefox selects the punctuation around a word when it is selected by double-clicking. If this is set to True, the punctuation is not selected with the word. If set to False, additional punctuation around the word is selected: you can choose whether double-clicking on the word "(Digit)" (without the quotes) should either select "default" or "(default)".



Another Essential Extension!

Head to www.softpedia.com/progDownload/Colorful-Tabs-Download-42192.html#download_locations. You'll find something there that you'll love! All your tabs are the same colour—this is not only not pretty, there's also some functionality to be gained if the tabs are in different colours. Go ahead, download that Extension—and view tabbed browsing differently! We had to mention this one because we loved it so much!